DND SESSION MANAGER

DM Guide

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Getting in

You log in with Discord and are the DM automatically. **Your very first job is inviting your players** — until you do, nobody else can get in, not even to look at their own character.

1. Open dnd.astralex.dev and click **Log in with Discord**. Discord asks once to share your username and avatar — nothing else.
2. You land on the **Dashboard**. Your name and a **DM** badge sit in the top right; the sidebar has **Manage**, which only you see.

Inviting players — do this first

Go to **Manage → Players** and type a player's Discord **username** under *Invite a player* — the unique one without spaces, not their display name (an `@` in front is fine). Then tell them to log in with Discord.

- Until their first login they show under *Invited, not logged in yet*; the ✕ there withdraws the invite.
- After it they move to *In this game*. The ✕ there removes them: they can't log in any more, but their characters and notes stay, and you can invite them again.
- Anyone who isn't invited sees *You're not invited yet* instead of the app.

Giving each character its player

A character belongs to one player's account, and only that player can edit it. Characters made before login existed start **unassigned** and are visible only to you. In **Manage → Players → Characters**, pick the player in the dropdown next to each character.

Assigning also moves old notes over automatically: notes saved under the character's player name go to that player, notes saved under the character's own name go into your notebook on that character.

Before the first session

Invite your players first (see Getting in) — everything below can wait, that can't. After that, everything you prepare lives under **Manage**; set it up in this order, because shops need currencies and the Board draws on all of it.

1. **Currencies** (Manage → Settings). Click **+ New Currency** for each coin: name, abbreviation, colour and value. Order them from most valuable (top) to smallest (bottom) with the arrows; the bottom one is the base unit (value 1). Values are only your reference — the app never converts between coins. A coin can't be deleted while shop items still price in it; the app lists which ones.

2. **Maps and books** (Manage → Documents). Upload PNG, JPG, WEBP or PDF files (up to 100 MB each) with a name, one map per room rather than one big map. Books are your reference material and appear on the Board as *Documents*. Upload replaces a file; sharing happens on the Board during play.
3. **Monsters** (Manage → Monsters). A monster is a template: name, its stat block as a PDF, and default HP. Live HP during a fight is tracked separately on the Board, so the template never changes.
4. **Shops** (Manage → Shops). **Create Shop** with a name, a location (e.g. *Waterdeep, Dock Ward* — already-used locations are suggested) and optional flavour text, then **+ Item** for each thing on sale: name, category, weight (lb), price and sale mode. A price can mix coins, e.g. 2 gold and 5 silver. Categories come from a fixed list — Armor and shields, Weapons, Adventuring gear, Tools, Spellcasting focus, Gemstones, Poisons, Miscellaneous — and the shop shows items grouped in that order. With many shops, the search box above the list finds a shop by name or location, and the *Location* dropdown shows one place at a time.
5. **Sessions** (Manage → Sessions). **+ Add Session** with a title, date and time, and your prep in *Session Notes (Prep)*. Sessions number themselves (Session 12, 13 …) and keep their number if you delete an earlier one.

Each shop item has one of two sale modes; **Set all items to…** in a shop's Edit form sets one mode for every item at once — it warns and asks before it overwrites anything.

Sale mode	Who can buy	Quantity you set
Shared Stock	Everyone, from one pile that runs down	Stock Quantity (empty = unlimited)
Per Player Limited	Each character on its own	Max Per Character

Players only ever see what you share with their character, so preparing all of this in advance gives nothing away.

Running a session on the Board

The **Board** is your cockpit during play: every panel updates live for everyone at the table, without reloading.

Panel	What you do there
Characters	Each character's HP at a glance. **View as** shows the Board exactly as that player sees it; **Sheet** opens their sheet (read-only for you).
Initiative	Type a name and value, tick *Monster* if it is one, **+ Entry** (or press Enter, then type the next name straight away). **Next Turn** moves the marker, **Clear** ends the fight. Players see the order live.
Dice	Pick a die, count and modifier, then roll — only you see your rolls. Rolled real dice? Keep the same dice selection, type the total and record it (shown as e.g. 5d12+3 → 35) — for yourself, or *For: ‹player›* to file it in that player's history. Results collect at the bottom of the panel; × removes one, **Clear all** empties your history.

Panel	What you do there
Timer	Label, length in seconds, who it's for — *Everyone*, or tick one or more characters — then **+ Start Timer**. For spells, effects and rituals. Only those characters' players see it count down (you see every timer, with *for ‹name›* under it); finished ones show *done* until you remove them with ×.
Monsters	Pick a template or *Custom monster*, set Max HP, **+ Monster**. Add the same template several times for several goblins; change each one's HP as it takes damage. **Clear Encounter** after the fight. Players never see this panel.
Shop	Pick a shop — the list is grouped by location, and the *Location* filter above it narrows it to one place. *Share with…* opens it for chosen characters — it pops open on their screen at once; **Share with everyone** opens it for every character in one go, **Unshare all** closes it for all. **Sell** sells for a player at the table: choose the buyer and quantity, and change the price if you haggled. Whatever is bought lands in the buyer's inventory with its weight, description and category; more of the same item adds to the count.
Maps	Click a map and tick who sees it under *Visible to* — or **Share with everyone** for the whole table at once (maps a player had hidden show again), **Unshare all** to take it back from everyone. Every map shows a small preview (PDFs their first page), and those players get a *View now / Later* pop-up. **Open big** shows the map almost full screen: zoom with the mouse wheel, pinch or the −/+ buttons, drag to move around, double-click to zoom in, **Fit** and **100%** to reset; **Open in new tab ↗** opens the file on its own, e.g. for a second screen. **End session** hides every shared map again, except maps a player locked.
Documents	The books from Manage → Documents, working exactly like Maps: preview, *Visible to*, **Share with everyone**, the big view. PDFs open in the browser's own viewer with its page and zoom controls. **End session** leaves documents alone — players keep their reference material.
Session Notes	Your prep for the next session by date (switchable), across the full width at the bottom of the Board and editable right here.
My Notes	Your private notebook, compact; **All pages ›** opens the Notes page.
Calculator	The four basic operations, for quick sums.

View as is for hybrid play: with a player's view open you can buy for them, toggle their maps or record a real-dice roll they made, and **Back to DM view** returns. Their notes, dice history and sheet stay private and read-only even then.

Characters, notes and quotes

You can read every character but edit none of them; your own writing lives in your notebooks and the quote list.

- **Characters** lists every player's characters with their owner, and *unassigned* on any you still need to give a player. A sheet opens read-only for you, with a note saying whose it is (**View inventory** shows their items as cards, also read-only) — levelling up, HP and everything else is the player's job, even for a replacement character after a death.

- **Notes** holds your private notebooks. *My notes* is your own; *Notes on ‹character›* is a running notebook per player character, not tied to any session. Each notebook has as many pages as you like; pages save with the **Save** button, not automatically.
- **Quotes** (Manage → Quotes) collects memorable lines: **+ Add Quote**, link it to a session and to the character whose player said it. A new quote starts hidden; its *Hidden* button switches it to *Shared*, and back; shared quotes appear on everyone's Dashboard. Filter the list by who said it and by session.
- **Session titles** you set in Manage → Sessions are visible to players; your prep notes in the same place are not.

Rules the tool follows

These are built in and checked on the server, so they hold no matter what anyone clicks.

- **Notes are private.** Only the person who wrote them can read them — you can't read players' notes, and they can't read yours.
- **Dice are private.** Everyone sees only their own last 5 rolls. A real-dice roll you record for a player lands in their history; you can't look at it afterwards.
- **Players see only what's theirs or shared.** Their own characters; maps, documents and shops shared with one of their characters; shared quotes; session titles; initiative; timers meant for everyone or for their character. Never monsters, your prep notes, or other players' sheets and notes.
- **Sharing is per character, never automatic.** A new character starts with nothing shared, even if the same player had maps before — share again deliberately.
- **Coins never convert.** A price must be paid in exactly the coins listed; enough value in other coins doesn't count. When you sell at the table you can change the price for that one sale.
- **Ability modifiers below 10 are your house rule:** each point below 10 is −1 (9 = −1, 8 = −2, 7 = −3). From 10 up it's standard 5e. The sheet marks this so it doesn't look like a mistake.
- **Level-up HP** adds the hit-die roll plus the Constitution modifier plus the proficiency bonus (your group's rule).
- **Replacement characters start from zero:** at most starter gear, no shared maps or shop access. The player brings level and abilities in line with the group.

Quick answers

Most hiccups at the table come down to an invite, an assignment, or a share to the wrong character.

Problem	What to do
A player sees *You're not invited yet*	Check Manage → Players: their exact Discord username, not the display name. Removed players need a new invite.
A player is in but sees no character	Assign it in Manage → Players → Characters.
A player can't find a shared map	Check you shared it with *that* character. They may have hidden it themselves: *Show hidden maps* at the bottom of their Maps panel.

Problem	What to do
A shop item shows red for a player	Their character lacks the exact coins listed. The player adds coins on their sheet, or you **Sell** it with an adjusted price.
You forgot to hide maps after a session	Press **End session** whenever — it only hides, nothing is unshared.
A player wants to undo a level-up or fix their sheet	Only they can edit it; the Danger Zone at the bottom of their sheet deletes the current level.
A page looks out of date	Reload it. The app always loads its newest version, and nothing is lost.
You need to hand the DM role to someone else	The DM is set on the server — ask Severin.
Something is actually broken	Tell Severin what you clicked and what you expected.